

Roll Number:

## CS4.301: Data and Applications (Monsoon 2024)

### Makeup Quiz

Maximum Marks: 15, Time: 40 minutes

- Keep answers concise. State all assumptions.
- All questions are compulsory.

### Question 1

| P  |    |    |  | Q  |    |   |  | R  |    |
|----|----|----|--|----|----|---|--|----|----|
| X  | Y  | Z  |  | X  | Y  | T |  | Y  | V  |
| X1 | Y1 | Z1 |  | X2 | Y1 | 5 |  | Y1 | V1 |
| X1 | Y1 | Z2 |  | X1 | Y2 | 3 |  | Y3 | V2 |
| X2 | Y2 | Z2 |  | X1 | Y1 | 2 |  | Y2 | V3 |
| X2 | Y4 | Z4 |  | X3 | Y3 | 8 |  | Y2 | V2 |

$$\pi_X(\sigma(P.Y = R.Y \wedge R.V = V2)(P \times R)) - \pi_X(\sigma(Q.Y = R.Y \wedge Q.T < 8)(Q \times R))$$

How many tuples will be returned? Show working.

(3 marks)

$$\pi_X ( \_ ) (P \times R)$$

|       |       |       |       |       |
|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
| P.X   | P.Y   | P.Z   | R.Y   | R.V   |
| $X_2$ | $Y_2$ | $Z_2$ | $Y_2$ | $V_2$ |

$$\pi_X ( \_ ) \rightarrow \textcircled{X_2} \quad \underline{1 \text{ mark}}$$

$$\pi ( \_ ) (Q \times R)$$

|       |       |   |       |       |
|-------|-------|---|-------|-------|
| $X_2$ | $Y_1$ | 5 | $Y_1$ | $V_1$ |
| $X_1$ | $Y_2$ | 3 | $Y_2$ | $V_3$ |
| $X_1$ | $Y_1$ | 2 | $Y_1$ | $V_1$ |

$$\pi_X ( \_ ) \rightarrow \{X_2, X_1\} \text{ or } (X_2, X_1, X_1)$$

1 mark

$$\{X_2\} - \{X_2, X_1\} = \emptyset$$

1 mark

## Question 2

Consider a relation  $R(A, B, C, D, E)$  that satisfies the following functional dependencies:  $\{ABC \rightarrow D, E \rightarrow B, AD \rightarrow C\}$ . Decompose the schema in BCNF.

(2 marks)

Answer :

$R_1(B, E)$  ,  $R_2(A, C, D)$  ,  $R_4(A, D, E)$  1 mark

1 mark for correct set of steps

Answer (Show the steps leading to the BCNF decomposition):

**Solution:** There are two solutions:

Solution 1:

| Table              | $X^+ = ?$      | New table 1       | New table 2       |
|--------------------|----------------|-------------------|-------------------|
| $R(A, B, C, D, E)$ | $ABC^+ = ABCD$ | $R_1(A, B, C, D)$ | $R_2(A, B, C, E)$ |
| $R_1(A, B, C, D)$  | $AD^+ = ACD$   | $R_3(A, C, D)$    | $R_4(A, B, D)$    |
| $R_2(A, B, C, E)$  | $E^+ = BE$     | $R_5(B, E)$       | $R_6(A, C, E)$    |

Answer:  $R_3(A, C, D), R_4(A, B, D), R_5(B, E), R_6(A, C, E)$ .

Solution 2:

| Table              | $X^+ = ?$    | New table 1    | New table 2       |
|--------------------|--------------|----------------|-------------------|
| $R(A, B, C, D, E)$ | $E^+ = BE$   | $R_1(B, E)$    | $R_2(A, C, D, E)$ |
| $R_2(A, C, D, E)$  | $AD^+ = ACD$ | $R_3(A, C, D)$ | $R_4(A, D, E)$    |

Answer:  $R_1(B, E), R_3(A, C, D), R_4(A, D, E)$ .

### Question 3

Let a prime attribute be one that appears in at least one candidate key. Let  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  be sets of attributes such that  $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$  holds, but  $\beta \rightarrow \alpha$  does not hold. Let  $A$  be an attribute that is not in  $\alpha$ , is not in  $\beta$ , and for which  $\beta \rightarrow A$  holds. We say that  $A$  is transitively dependent on  $\alpha$ . We can restate our definition of 3NF as follows: A relation schema  $R$  is in 3NF with respect to a set  $F$  of functional dependencies if there are no nonprime attributes  $A$  in  $R$  for which  $A$  is transitively dependent on a key for  $R$ . Show that this new definition is equivalent to the original one.

(4 marks)

Suppose  $R$  is in 3NF according to the textbook definition. We show that it is in 3NF according to the definition in the exercise. Let  $A$  be a nonprime attribute in  $R$  that is transitively dependent on a key  $\alpha$  for  $R$ . Then there exists  $\beta \subseteq R$  such that  $\beta \rightarrow A$ ,  $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ ,  $A \notin \alpha$ ,  $A \notin \beta$ , and  $\beta \rightarrow \alpha$  does not hold. But then  $\beta \rightarrow A$  violates the textbook definition of 3NF since

- $A \notin \beta$  implies  $\beta \rightarrow A$  is nontrivial.
- Since  $\beta \rightarrow \alpha$  does not hold,  $\beta$  is not a superkey.
- $A$  is not in any candidate key, since  $A$  is nonprime.

Now we show that if  $R$  is in 3NF according to the exercise definition, it is in 3NF according to the textbook definition. Suppose  $R$  is not in 3NF according to the textbook definition. Then there is a functional dependency  $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$  that fails all three conditions. Thus,

- $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$  is nontrivial.
- $\alpha$  is not a superkey for  $R$ .
- Some  $A$  in  $\beta - \alpha$  is not in any candidate key.

This implies that  $A$  is nonprime and  $\alpha \rightarrow A$ . Let  $\gamma$  be a candidate key for  $R$ . Then  $\gamma \rightarrow \alpha$ ,  $\alpha \rightarrow \gamma$  does not hold (since  $\alpha$  is not a superkey),  $A \notin \alpha$ , and  $A \notin \gamma$  (since  $A$  is nonprime). Thus  $A$  is transitively dependent on  $\gamma$ , violating the exercise definition.

1.5 mark for correct textbook/general definition of a table being in 3NF form

1 mark for highlighting the new definition in formal mathematical notation

1.5 mark for proving the transitive dependency

Not a formal proof is required, explanation based proof also works

Note : The restated definition is the one defined by Codd and is known as 'Codd's definition' for 3NF



### 14.4.2 General Definition of Third Normal Form

**Definition.** A relation schema  $R$  is in **third normal form (3NF)** if, whenever a *nontrivial* functional dependency  $X \rightarrow A$  holds in  $R$ , either (a)  $X$  is a superkey of  $R$ , or (b)  $A$  is a prime attribute of  $R$ .<sup>13</sup>

## Question 4

SQL provides an  $n$ -ary operation called coalesce, which is defined as follows:

$\text{coalesce}(A_1, A_2, \dots, A_n)$  returns the first nonnull  $A_i$  in the list  $A_1, A_2, \dots, A_n$ , and returns *null* if all of  $A_1, A_2, \dots, A_n$  are *null*.

Let  $a$  and  $b$  be relations with the schemas  $A(\text{name}, \text{address}, \text{title})$ , and  $B(\text{name}, \text{address}, \text{salary})$ , respectively. Show how to express a natural full outer join  $b$  using the full outer-join operation with an on condition and the coalesce operation. Make sure that the result relation does not contain two copies of the attributes *name* and *address*, and that the solution is correct even if some tuples in  $a$  and  $b$  have null values for attributes *name* or *address*.

**(4 marks)**

```
SELECT COALESCE(a.name, b.name) AS name,  
       COALESCE(a.address, b.address) AS address,  
       a.title,  
       b.salary  
FROM a FULL OUTER JOIN b  
     ON a.name = b.name AND  
        a.address = b.address;
```

1.5 mark for highlighting the idea /explanation ,

2 marks for the correct query ( partial marks based on combination of explanation and written query)

0.5 marks for correct join conditions

It's an easy question if you get the definition right

Note: 4 for correct query and a detailed answer/ thought process of getting to the answer

Max 1 for similar idea





## Question 5

Rewrite the following query without using the with construct. The query must run; no partial marks will be awarded.

```
with dept_total (dept_name, value) as
    (select dept_name, sum(salary)
     from instructor
     group by dept_name),
dept_total_avg (value) as
    (select avg (value)
     from dept_total)
select dept_name
from dept_total, dept_total_avg
where dept_total.value >= dept_total_avg.value;
```

(2 marks)

```
SELECT dept_name
FROM (SELECT dept_name, SUM(salary) AS value FROM instructor GROUP BY
dept_name) AS dept_total,
(SELECT AVG(value) AS value FROM (SELECT dept_name, SUM(salary) AS value
FROM instructor GROUP BY dept_name) AS x) AS dept_total_avg
WHERE dept_total.value >= dept_total_avg.value
```

2 marks for correct query ( No partial marking )